Ratan's signature way to get the Tata fraternity to give their best was by constantly prodding the senior management to push the envelope. 'He will not taunt you, but get you thinking,' Chandrasekaran says. Ratan kept urging the leaders to 'think high, never worry about failures', says Ramadorai.

By 2005, the global IT companies increasingly realized the 'depth of India's base of knowledge workers' and were 'keen to leverage the country's cost competitiveness as an integral part of their business strategy'. In the light of this encouraging development, TCS pushed its strategic plan to 'become a complete solutions company and provide higher value solutions to its customers'. Simultaneously, it strengthened its 'domain-specific offerings and end-to-end solutions' that would 'lead to higher value contracts'. As a supporting strategy, it stepped up 'efforts to increase its visibility across the globe through intense marketing and branding campaigns'.

To cater to the increasing demand and expand the repertoire of its offerings, TCS emphasized growth 'through inorganic means via mergers and acquisitions' and by tapping 'unexplored opportunities in Eastern Europe, Russia and China' through global delivery centres or in the form of potential markets. With the domestic market also 'ripe for growth', it continued its efforts to be a 'committed player in India'. With that, the company commenced a landmark project with the Indian government to 'put the entire database of company records online [and also] helped many states implement VAT [Value Added Tax]'.

Ratan's increasing emphasis on expanding the company's overseas presence brought it greater visibility, resulting in offers from new customers. For instance, the company was 'invited by the Chinese government to form a Joint Venture (JV) supported by the National Development and Reforms Commission (NDRC) to create a large scale global offshoring base in China'. The purpose of the JV was to cater to the IT service and software needs—including business process outsourcing (BPO)—of China, the Asia-Pacific region and the global market.

By the mid-2000s, TCS began bagging multiple high-value contracts both overseas and in India. At the 2006 TCS AGM, Ratan said: 'We aim to become among the top ten (IT companies worldwide) by 2010 with revenues touching $10 billion over the next four years. The company will leverage the booming IT industry which is witnessing rapid growth during